SADC HUMANITARIAN AND EMERGENCY OPERATIONS CENTRE

TRAINING MANUAL

Emergency Response Teams

Activation | Mobilisation | In-Country Operations | Transition & Demobilisation | Transboundary Cooperation

Based on SOP Volume 4, Version 5.1 — March 2026

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Annexes Reference:	39 Operational Templates (Annex A–AM)
Target Audience:	ERT Coordinators, Field Leads, ERT Members, NDMA Counterparts

Aligned to: UNDAC Handbook 8th Ed. (2024) | IFRC ERU | AHA Centre ERAT | INSARAG | WHO IHR (2005)

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1. Introduction and Purpose

This Training Manual is a companion document to SHOC SOP Volume 4: Emergency Response Teams, Version 5.1. It provides ERT Coordinators, ERT Field Leads, deployed ERT members, and NDMA counterparts with practical, SOP-by-SOP guidance on the complete ERT mission lifecycle from activation through post-mission reporting.

The manual covers all four constituent SOPs: **SOP 4.1 (Activation and Mobilisation), SOP 4.2 (In-Country Operations Protocol), SOP 4.3 (Transition, Demobilisation and Post-Mission Reporting), and SOP 4.4 (Transboundary Cooperation).**

Trainees should use this manual alongside the full SOP text and the 39 Operational Annexes (A–AM). The SOPs provide the authoritative procedural requirements; this manual translates those requirements into a concise operational learning guide.

Sovereignty Safeguard: SHOC does not substitute for national response capacity. ERTs operate in support of, and under the operational authority of, the designated NDMAs. Deployment and operational command remain under national sovereign authority at all times.

2. Terms and Key Definitions

The following terms are essential to this training manual. A full glossary is provided in the SOP, Section 4.

Abbreviation	Full Form
AAR	After-Action Review
CBCC	Cross-Border Coordination Cell
ERT	Emergency Response Team
ICP	International Cooperating Partner
IM	Information Management
NDMA	National Disaster Management Authority
OSSHOC	On-Site SADC Humanitarian Operations Centre
PoA	Plan of Action
POR	Programme Officer Response
PSEA	Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse
SHOC	SADC Humanitarian and Emergency Operations Centre
SitRep	Situation Report
UNDSS	United Nations Department of Safety and Security

3. How to Use This Manual

This manual follows the four-SOP structure of Volume 4. Each SOP section provides:

- SOP Purpose: What the SOP achieves and why it matters.
- Key Tasks: Summarises critical actions in the correct sequence.
- Annex Toolkit: Identifies which Annexes to use at each step.
- Quick Reference Table: Condensed task-output-timeline summary.
- Trainer's Notes: Common errors, exercise scenarios, and assessment cues.

3.1 SHOC Mission Cycle

SHOC uses descriptive phase names aligned to the UNDAC 8th Edition:

Phase	UNDAC Equiv.	Description
Watch	Pre-Mission (M0)	Continuous monitoring; no deployment action
Alert	Alert (M1)	Alert issued to deployable roster; members indicate availability
Standby	Standby (M2)	Team selected; members prepare for departure; sign attestations
Dispatch	Dispatch (M3a)	Final composition confirmed; Pre-Deployment Briefing; ERT departs
Stand Down	Stand Down (M3b)	Cancellation when deployment no longer required

4. SOP 4.1: Activation and Mobilisation

SOP Reference: ERT Activation and Mobilisation (Sections 1–12)

4.1 Purpose

SOP 4.1 establishes the procedure for activation and mobilisation of SADC ERTs. It covers the full mobilisation cycle from NDMA request receipt through to ERT dispatch, managed entirely through the SHOC ERT Portal.

4.2 The 9-Step Portal Mobilisation Workflow

Step	Transaction	Key Actions	Timeline
1	Government Request	Formal request via NDMA and SADC National Focal Point with situational analysis	On receipt
2	Alert	ERT Coordinator identifies profiles; POR triggers automated notification to eligible roster	Within 2hr
3	Availability	Roster members confirm/decline via Portal; captures passport, airport, restrictions	24hr from Alert
4	Shortlist	ERT Coordinator finalises team against competencies, language, gender balance	Within 6hr
5	Standby	Selected members receive standby notification; sign attestation, Code of Conduct	Within 4hr
6	Travel	Air tickets, visas, entry permits, per diem, SADC ERT ID, mission kit assembly	12–24hr
7	Briefing	Mandatory 9-component briefing 2–4 hours before departure (see Section 8)	2–4hr pre-departure
8	Logistics	Travel confirmation, accommodation, comms setup, equipment	Parallel to Step 7
9	Dispatch	Supply Chain Officer issues final notification; Field Lead assumes transit command	48–72hr from Step 1

4.3 Annex Toolkit for SOP 4.1

Annex	Title	Use
A	ERT Mobilisation Checklist	Verify all actions, personnel, equipment before deployment
B	Team Readiness Evaluation Form	Assess personnel and equipment readiness per IFRC/UNDAC
C	Pre-Deployment Briefing Record	Record completion of mandatory 9-component briefing
D	Travel and Entry Clearance Tracker	Track visa, travel, and entry clearance for all members
AI–AK	Mission Info Pack; Contact Card; Field Lead Checklist	Pre-departure operational tools

4.4 Trainer's Notes

Critical learning point: The ERT Coordinator is the central node in the interoperability chain. Simulate a scenario where <80% of roster members respond within 24 hours and require the trainee to identify the correct escalation pathway. Also test whether trainees can execute a Stand Down correctly — reason recorded, all member statuses reset to READY in the Portal.

5. SOP 4.2: In-Country Operations Protocol

SOP Reference: In-Country Operations Protocol (Sections 1–9)

5.1 Purpose

SOP 4.2 governs ERT operations upon arrival in a disaster-affected Member State: reception, integration into national coordination, joint assessment, reporting, information management, community engagement, and transboundary coordination where applicable.

Command principle: Operational command remains fully under the NDMA Director at all times. The ERT operates under the overall authority of the affected Member State's NDMA.

5.2 Procedural Phases and Time Thresholds

Phase	Window	Key Actions	Annex
1. Arrival & Reception	0–6 hours	Report to NDMA; Arrival Briefing; community leader engagement within 24hr	J
2. Integration	6–12 hours	Integrate into EOC; daily meetings with NDMA, UN, NGOs; establish OSSHOC within 8hr	J, K, N
3. Joint Assessment	12–48 hours	Joint needs assessments led by NDMA with ERT support; UNDAC Rapid Assessment	M
4. SitReps	24hr cycle	SitReps every 24 hours compiled by IM Officer, approved by Field Lead	L
5. Community Engagement	Ongoing	Engage community representatives; feedback mechanisms; indigenous knowledge	P
6. Transboundary	If applicable	CBCC activation; National Cross-Border Desks; Joint Operations Plan	See SOP 4.4

5.3 Operational Briefing Cycle and 72-Hour Reviews

Mandatory daily briefings for first 7 days (default 08:00 local), then minimum 3x/week. Attendance recorded using Annex AM. Structured 72-Hour In-Progress Reviews cover: operational progress, resource status, personnel welfare, partner coordination, escalation decisions.

5.4 Annex Toolkit for SOP 4.2

Annex	Title	Phase
J	ERT In-Country Integration Checklist	1–2
K	EOC Liaison Contact List (Restricted)	2
L	Situation Report (SitRep) Template	4 (24hr cycle)
M	Joint Assessment Template	3
N	OSSHOC Establishment Checklist	2
O	Risk Log Template	All phases

P	Community Engagement Plan Template	5
AM	Operational Briefing Roster Template	Daily briefings

5.5 Trainer's Notes

Practical exercise: Set up a tabletop exercise simulating the first 48 hours in-country. Require trainees to complete Integration Checklist (Annex J), establish OSSHOC (Annex N), produce the first SitRep (Annex L), and initiate joint assessment (Annex M) under realistic time pressure. Test that command remains with the NDMA Director.

6. SOP 4.3: Transition, Demobilisation and Post-Mission

SOP Reference: Transition, Demobilisation and Post-Mission Reporting (Sections 1–4)

6.1 Purpose

SOP 4.3 governs the shift from active emergency operations to orderly national handover, phased demobilisation, post-mission reporting, After-Action Review, individual performance evaluation, and knowledge management.

Critical distinction: The Close-Out Meeting (forward-looking, chaired by ERT Field Lead, 7–3 days before end) is fundamentally different from the After-Action Review (backward-looking, chaired by SHOC Director, 7–21 days post-demobilisation). The SADC SHOC model formally separates these processes.

6.2 Procedural Phases

Phase	Timeline	Key Actions	Annex
Close-Out Meeting	7–3 days before end	Operational handover event; outstanding items, partner continuity, community transition	F
Operational Handover	7–3 days before end	Sector-specific handovers to national cluster leads; data/contacts transferred to NDMA	Q
Demobilisation	Final 3 days	Phased withdrawal; performance debriefs; HR close-out; Portal → DEMOBILISED	E
Asset Management	Final 3 days	4-step protocol: Inventory, Disposition, Reconciliation, Portal Update. No departure until reconciled	AL
After-Action Review	7–21 days post-demob	What Planned? What Happened? Why? How to Improve? SHOC Director chairs	H, I
Performance Evaluation	Final 48 hours	5-domain competency assessment with 360-degree feedback	G
Final Reporting	21–30 days post-demob	Final Mission Report; archive within 35 days; Regional Briefing within 45 days	R, S, T, U, V

6.3 Trainer's Notes

Assessment focus: The Asset Management Protocol has a hard gate: no departure until Annex AL is signed by Field Lead and countersigned by Coordinator. Discrepancies >USD 2,000 escalate to SHOC Director. Simulate a scenario with an equipment discrepancy and require trainees to follow the correct escalation.

7. SOP 4.4: Transboundary Cooperation

SOP Reference: Transboundary Cooperation (Sections 1–5)

7.1 Purpose

SOP 4.4 applies when the SHOC Director determines that an emergency spans or threatens multiple SADC Member States. It establishes the Cross-Border Coordination Cell (CBCC), National Cross-Border Desks, joint operations planning, and harmonised information exchange.

7.2 Operational Phases

Phase	Timeline	Key Actions	Annex
CBCC Activation	0–24 hours	SHOC Director declares activation; CBCC established; National Desks activated; Data-Sharing signed	W, AF, Z
Joint Ops Planning	24–48 hours	JOP developed; humanitarian corridors mapped; access requests processed; risk comms issued	Y, AG, AB, AC
Sustained Coordination	Ongoing	Joint planning 2x weekly; CB-SitRep consolidated; resource harmonisation	X
CBCC Deactivation	End of need	Deactivation Checklist; Cross-Border AAR within 21 days; Regional Synthesis within 45 days	AD, AA, AE

7.3 Annex Toolkit for SOP 4.4

Annex	Title
W	CBCC Terms of Reference
X	Cross-Border SitRep Template
Y	Joint Operations Plan Template
Z	Data-Sharing Agreement
AA	Cross-Border AAR Template
AB	Humanitarian Access Request Form
AC	Cross-Border Risk Communication Template
AD	CBCC Deactivation Checklist
AE	Regional Lessons-Learnt Synthesis
AF	CBCC Organogram
AG	Priority Corridors Map Template

8. Pre-Deployment Briefing Protocol

The 9-component Pre-Deployment Briefing is a mandatory control point for mission coherence, safety, interoperability, and accountability. Chaired by the SHOC Programme Head, 2–4 hours before ERT departure.

#	Component	Delivered By	Duration
1	Disaster Profile (hazard, scale, myDEWETRA/INFORM data)	Situation Room Analyst	15 min
2	Operational Objectives (mandate, KPIs, timeline)	ERT Coordinator	30 min
3	Command Structure (SHOC–NDMA–OSSHOC lines)	ERT Coordinator	40 min
4	Security (UNDSS level, threats, no-go zones, evacuation)	Security Focal Point	15 min
5	Cultural/Legal (protocols, language EN/FR/PT, media)	SHOC Director / PRO	20 min
6	Logistics/Admin (travel, visa, accommodation, comms, IT)	Deployment Coordinator	40 min
7	Welfare/Duty of Care (stress, psychosocial, rotation, health)	HR / Welfare Officer	30 min
8	Conduct & Guidance (dress, media, CoC, PSEA, spouse)	SHOC Director / Coordinator	30 min
9	Sign-Off (Q&A, Annex C sign-off, Mission Info Pack issued)	Head of Operations	10 min

Annex C (Pre-Deployment Briefing Record) must be completed and signed by all ERT members before departure. No dispatch proceeds without a completed Annex C.

9. Annex Toolkit Quick Reference

The following table maps all 39 Annexes to their applicable SOP.

Annex	Title	SOP
A	ERT Mobilisation Checklist	4.1
B	Team Readiness Evaluation Form	4.1
C	Pre-Deployment Briefing Record	4.1
D	Travel and Entry Clearance Tracker	4.1
E	Demobilisation Inventory and Handover	4.1/4.3
F	Close-Out Meeting Minutes Template	4.3
G	Individual ERT Performance Evaluation	4.3
H–I	After-Action Report; Lessons Learned Capture	4.1/4.3
J	ERT In-Country Integration Checklist	4.2
K	EOC Liaison Contact List	4.2
L	Situation Report (SitRep) Template	4.2
M	Joint Assessment Template	4.2
N	OSSHOC Establishment Checklist	4.2
O	Risk Log Template	4.2
P	Community Engagement Plan	4.2
Q–V	Handover, End-of-Mission, AAR, Financial, Knowledge, Close-Out	4.3
W–AG	Transboundary: CBCC TOR, CB-SitRep, JOP, Data-Sharing, CB-AAR, Corridors, Comms, Deactivation, Lessons, Organogram, Map	4.4
AH	Communication Security Protocol	All
AI–AK	Mission Info Pack; Contact Card; Field Lead Checklist	4.1
AL	Asset Management and Reconciliation Checklist	4.3
AM	Operational Briefing Roster Template	4.2

10. Contact and Escalation Reference

Trainees must know the escalation matrix. The ERT Field Lead is always first point of contact.

Problem	First Contact	Escalation	Portal Action
Mission order query	ERT Field Lead	Head of Operations	View mission order
Travel disruption	ERT Field Lead	ERT Coordinator	HR logs rebooking
Lost passport	ERT Field Lead	NDMA DRR Focal Point	Emergency ID via Portal
Security concern	ERT Field Lead	Security FP → SHOC Director	Security incident report
Medical emergency	ERT Field Lead	HR/Welfare → SHOC Director	Medevac protocol
PSEA complaint	ERT Field Lead	NDMA Director or SHOC Director	Confidential channel
Disagreement with NDMA	ERT Field Lead	ERT Coordinator → Head of Ops	Log in 72-Hour Review
Equipment failure	ERT Field Lead	ERT Coordinator	Logistics request

11. Performance Evaluation Framework

Individual ERT performance is assessed using a 5-domain competency framework with 360-degree feedback (Annex G).

Domain (Weight)	Criteria Summary	Assessment Source
Technical/Specialist (30%)	Expertise; quality of outputs; methodology	Field Lead + Peer
Coordination/Teamwork (25%)	NDMA/ICP coordination; cluster work; conflict resolution	NDMA Liaison + Field Lead
Communication/Reporting (20%)	SitRep quality; verbal clarity; IM platform use	IM Officer + Field Lead
Professional Conduct (15%)	Code of Conduct; cultural sensitivity; initiative	SHOC Director + NDMA
Adaptability/Resilience (10%)	Performance under pressure; flexibility; self-care	Field Lead + Peer

Score linkage: ≥4.0 = priority deployment; 3.0–3.9 = standard roster; <3.0 = improvement plan; <2.0 in any domain = remedial. Nominating NDMA formally notified when eligibility affected.

12. Assessment and Competency Verification

Competency in SHOC ERT operations is assessed through practical exercises and knowledge verification.

Competency	Assessment Method	Minimum Standard
9-Step Portal Workflow	Scenario: execute Steps 1–9 under time pressure	All steps completed correctly
Pre-Deployment Briefing	Role-play: deliver assigned component	Annex C completed and signed
NDMA Integration (48hr)	Tabletop: complete Annexes J, N, L, M	All forms complete; correct command structure
SitRep production	Complete Annex L from scenario data	All sections complete; within 24hr
72-Hour Review	Role-play: lead review session	All seven agenda items covered
Close-Out vs AAR distinction	Written test: identify differences	Correct purpose, chair, timing
Asset Management Protocol	Practical: reconcile against register	Annex AL completed; all items reconciled
CBCC activation	Scenario: activate CBCC with Annexes W, Z, AF	CBCC within 24hr; Data-Sharing signed
Performance evaluation	Complete Annex G for simulated member	All 5 domains; 360-degree sources
Escalation matrix	Scenario: resolve 3 escalation situations	Correct first contact and escalation

Certification requirement: ERT Coordinators and Field Leads must demonstrate competency across all ten areas before assuming operational roles. SIMEX exercises provide the primary assessment vehicle. Results recorded in the SHOC ERT Database and reviewed by the Head of Operations.

— END OF TRAINING MANUAL —